

B2 Essay Linkers and Connectors for First Certificate Exam

Adding Information

Furthermore - Use this to add extra supporting points to strengthen your argument.

Moreover - Similar to furthermore, this connector helps build upon your previous statement.

In addition - A clear way to introduce additional information or examples.

What is more - An effective phrase to emphasize that you have even more evidence to support your point.

Not only... but also - This structure allows you to present two related ideas with emphasis on both.

Showing Contrast and Opposition

However - The most common way to introduce an opposing viewpoint or contrasting information.

Nevertheless - Use this when you want to show that despite previous information, your point still stands.

On the other hand - Perfect for presenting the opposite side of an argument or different perspective.

Although - Introduces a contrasting clause within the same sentence.

Despite the fact that - A more formal way to show contrast while acknowledging opposing information.

While - Useful for showing simultaneous contrast between two ideas.

Expressing Cause and Effect

Consequently - Shows a direct result of previously mentioned information.

As a result - A clear connector that links causes to their effects.

Therefore - Indicates a logical conclusion based on the evidence presented.

Due to - Introduces the reason or cause behind a particular outcome.

Owing to - A more formal alternative to "due to" for academic writing.

For this reason - Explains why something happens based on previous statements.

Giving Examples and Clarification

For instance - Introduces a specific example to illustrate your point.

For example - The most straightforward way to provide concrete examples.

Such as - Used when listing examples within a sentence.

In particular - Highlights one specific aspect or example from a broader category.

That is to say - Helps clarify or rephrase your previous statement in simpler terms.

In other words - Useful for explaining complex ideas in a different way.

Sequencing and Organization

Firstly/Secondly/Finally - Essential for organizing your essay into clear, logical sections.

To begin with - A sophisticated way to introduce your first main point.

Subsequently - Shows that one event or idea follows another in time or logic.

Meanwhile - Indicates that something else is happening at the same time.

Eventually - Shows the final outcome after a series of events or processes.

Expressing Opinion and Attitude

In my opinion - A direct way to present your personal viewpoint.

From my perspective - A more sophisticated alternative to express your opinion.

It seems to me that - A softer way to present your viewpoint without being too direct.

Personally - Emphasizes that the following statement reflects your individual view.

Undoubtedly - Shows strong certainty about your statement.

Concluding and Summarizing

In conclusion - The standard way to introduce your final paragraph and main conclusions.

To sum up - A clear signal that you are summarizing your main points.

All things considered - Shows that you have weighed different aspects before reaching your conclusion.

On the whole - Indicates your overall assessment after considering various factors.

Taking everything into account - Demonstrates comprehensive consideration of all relevant points.

Emphasizing Important Points

Above all - Highlights the most important point among several options.

Most importantly - Draws attention to the key aspect of your argument.

It should be emphasized that - A formal way to stress crucial information.

Particularly - Focuses attention on one specific aspect that deserves special notice.

Especially - Similar to particularly, but slightly less formal in tone.

Making Comparisons

Similarly - Shows that two things share common characteristics or patterns.

Likewise - Indicates that the same principle applies to different situations.

In the same way - Draws parallels between different examples or situations.

Compared to - Introduces direct comparisons between two or more items.

Unlike - Highlights differences between contrasting examples or situations.